

Answer Keys, Rubrics & Next Steps

Everything you need to score Progress Test 1 (Class 13) and the Final Test (Class 26): answers and point values, acceptable alternatives, the errors to expect, CEFR-aligned speaking and writing rubrics, what the scores mean for each learner's next class, and how to give the news kindly.

Progress Test 1 /70

Final Test /100

Rubric bands: Not yet B1 • B1 • B1+

Confidential • teacher only

SCORING PRINCIPLES

Score meaning, not spelling, in Listening and Reading: an answer that shows understanding gets the point, even if it is misspelled ("they leve erly"). In Words & Phrases the word must be recognizable, so a small slip (*experiance*, *deadlin*) earns the point, but a different word does not. Circle items are right or wrong. **Rewrites** (Progress Test 3B) earn the point only when the target structure is correct; ignore small spelling slips. Writing and speaking use the checklists and rubrics below. Half points are not used. The tests use American English; **accept British forms everywhere** (the online lessons use many: *flat*, *holiday*, *film*, *practise*, *organise*, *colour*, *car park*, *the shops*).

AT A GLANCE

SECTION	PROGRESS TEST 1 (MODULES 1–4)	FINAL TEST (MODULES 1–8)
 Listening	12 items • 1 pt each • /12	15 items • 1 pt each • /15
 Words & phrases	5 gap-fill + 5 functions • /10	5 work words + 5 phrasal verbs + 5 situations • /15
 Grammar	10 circle + 5 rewrites • /15	20 circle • /20
 Reading	6 Yes/No/Doesn't say + 2 short answers • /8	Story 8 + job ad 7 • /15
 Writing	Advice reply 4 + opinion paragraph 6 • /10	Complaint email 8 + opinion essay rubric 12 • /20
 Speaking	Pair task, rubric 5 × 0–3 • /15	Interview, rubric 5 × 0–3 • /15
Total	/70 (written /55)	/100 (written /85)

PROGRESS TEST 1 · ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 · LISTENING /12

1	She's been working all day.	listen for the weak <i>been</i> /bɪn/ + -ing
2	If I had more time, I'd help you.	the short 'd is the clue
3	He told me he was busy.	backshift: <i>was</i>
4	The school was built in 1990.	passive
5	8 years	"for eight years"
6	grandmother	
7	a parking lot	
8	Sundays	Saturdays = the old market
9	Amir	
10	Lena	
11	Both	Lena says it; Amir: "I couldn't agree more"
12	in the evening	

◆ PART 2 · WORDS & PHRASES /10

1	yet	6	c
2	since	7	a
3	unless	8	b
4	whose	9	d
5	whether	10	f

Extras: *still* (A) and *e* (B). For 5, accept *if* (correct, though not in the box). For 1, *still* is wrong in that position (*I still haven't finished* needs a different word order).

◆ PART 4 · READING /8

1	Yes	twenty-two years
2	No	"every child who walked past"
3	Yes	"built in its place"
4	No	"I don't completely agree"
5	Doesn't say	the park is full of families, but Luis isn't mentioned there
6	No	"she hasn't found anything ... yet"
7	They leave early and come home late / they work downtown.	either idea
8	She would move there (to Carver Street) tomorrow.	accept "move here", "live near him"

◆ PART 3 · GRAMMAR /15 · WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	met	finished time (<i>last Saturday</i>) → past simple; <i>have met ... last Saturday</i> is the classic error	1.1
2	since	a start point → <i>since</i> ; a length → <i>for</i>	1.1
3	have been cleaning	activity with a present result (tired) → continuous	1.2
4	have known	<i>know</i> is stative: no continuous	1.2
5	used to	<i>have</i> (= own) is a state; <i>would</i> only for repeated actions	1.3
6	rains	no <i>will</i> after <i>if</i>	2.1
7	were	fixed advice phrase <i>If I were you</i>	2.2
8	could	ability: <i>wish</i> + <i>could</i> ; <i>I wish I can</i> is common	2.3
9	are cleaned	present simple passive; the trains don't clean anything	4.1
10	can't	negative deduction = <i>can't</i> , never <i>mustn't</i>	4.2
11	(that) he was moving to Denver the next month.	backshift <i>am</i> → <i>was</i> , <i>I</i> → <i>he</i> . Accept <i>the following month</i> or <i>next month</i> (if reported soon after). No point for <i>he is moving</i> or <i>told me that I was</i> .	3.1
12	where I worked.	statement order, no <i>do</i> , no <i>"?"</i> . Accept <i>where I work</i> (still true). No point for <i>where did I work</i> / <i>where do I work</i> .	3.2
13	not to be late.	<i>ask</i> + <i>person</i> + <i>not to</i> . No point for <i>to not be late</i> or <i>don't be late</i> .	3.2
14	who / that speaks four languages.	subject pronoun: can't drop it. No point for <i>who she speaks</i> (double subject).	3.3
15	was stolen last night.	<i>was</i> + past participle. Accept <i>by someone</i> (point given), but note it: the lesson teaches to drop an empty agent.	4.1

◆ PART 5 • WRITING /10

- ◆ **A. Reply with advice (4 × 1 pt).** +1 a greeting and a reaction or friendly ending. +1 clear advice in a correct pattern (*If I were you, I'd... · I think you should... · I wouldn't...*). +1 a reason, or a consequence with a first or second conditional (*If you take it, you'll...*). +1 the whole reply is understandable and on topic. Spelling slips don't lose points here.
- ◆ **B. Opinion paragraph (6 pts).** Task 0–2: 2 = a clear opinion + two reasons + an example + a conclusion, about 80–100 words; 1 = an opinion with only one reason, no example, or under 60 words. **Organization 0–1:** at least two linkers or opinion phrases used correctly (*In my opinion, The main reason is, For example, What's more, On the other hand*). **Range 0–1:** at least one structure from Modules 1–4 used naturally (a conditional, a relative

clause, *used to*, a passive, *I wish*). **Accuracy 0–2:** 2 = errors are few and never stop meaning; 1 = frequent errors, but the message is clear; 0 = meaning often lost.

Model answer A (4/4): Hi Kim! Congratulations, that's great news. If I were you, I'd take the job, because it's a great chance for your career. You can visit your family on weekends. Good luck, and let me know what you decide!

Model answer B (6/6, 95 words): In my opinion, it is better to live in a small town. The main reason is that life is calmer and cheaper. For example, my cousin, who lives in a small town, pays half the rent that I pay. What's more, people know their neighbors and help each other. On the other hand, there are fewer jobs, and you often need a car. If I lived in a small town, I would miss the restaurants. So, all in all, a small town is better for families, but a big city is better for young people looking for work.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (PROGRESS TEST 1)

- ◆ **Present perfect with a finished time** ("I have met her last Saturday", item 1) and **the present tense for "how long"** ("I live here since 2019"). Speakers of Spanish, French, German, Portuguese, and Russian transfer their own patterns. Recycle the Lesson 1.1 golden rule in warmers.
- ◆ **Continuous with stative verbs** ("I've been knowing her", item 4) and **would for states** ("I would have a bike", item 5).
- ◆ **"If it will rain..."** (6), **"If I was you"** (7: common in speech, but the paper tests the standard form), **"I wish I can..."** (8).
- ◆ **Reported questions with question order** ("asked me where did I work", item 12) and **"to not be late"** (13). These take many short drills.
- ◆ **"mustn't" for a negative deduction** (10): the single most common modal error at this level. **Dropped be in the passive** ("The trains cleaned every night"): Chinese, Vietnamese, and Arabic L1.
- ◆ **Writing:** an opinion with no reason ("It's better. I like it."), and every sentence starting with "I think". Praise the reason before you correct the grammar.

FINAL TEST · ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 · LISTENING /15

1	walking past the center	9	3–5 days
2	had never volunteered	10	a replacement
3	Tuesdays	11	a) Did you?
4	got a new job	12	b) I see your point, but...

◆ PART 2 · WORDS & PHRASES /15

1	apply	9	up
2	responsible	10	on
3	deadline	11	Would it be possible to get a refund?
4	experience	12	To sum up, ...
5	colleague	13	I see your point, but ...
6	off	14	I couldn't agree more.

5	cooking	13	a) I'm good at solving problems...
6	Monday	14	b) I'm terribly sorry...
7	doesn't work	15	a) Yes, it is.
8	47159		

7	after	15	What's your view on this?
8	out		

Extras: *position* (A; *strengths* is used in the example) and *with* (B). For 10, *get on with* is the phrasal verb, but only *on* fits the gap before *really well*. Accept *co-worker* for 5.

Item 10: the refund is for the *double charge*; for the machine he asks for a replacement. Learners who circle "a refund" heard only the first half. Item 11: the line is past simple ("I passed... yesterday"), so the echo is *Did you?*

◆ PART 3 • GRAMMAR / 20 • WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	have been	experience, no finished time	1.1
2	have you been waiting	how long + still happening → present perfect continuous	1.2
3	would	repeated past action with a time frame (<i>every summer</i>)	1.3
4	have	no <i>will</i> after <i>if</i>	2.1
5	had	unreal → past form after <i>if</i> ; <i>would</i> belongs in the result	2.2
6	would	annoyance about someone else's behavior	2.3
7	told me	tell + person, no <i>to</i> ; say takes no person	3.1
8	I lived	statement order in reported questions	3.2
9	who	non-defining (commas) → no <i>that</i>	3.3
10	was built	past date → past passive	4.1
11	must	positive deduction from evidence	4.2
12	had left	the earlier action → past perfect	5.1
13	was cooking	background interrupted by a sudden event	5.2
14	get	present simple after <i>as soon as</i>	5.3
15	will be watching	in progress at a future moment	5.3
16	an	jobs take a/an; vowel sound	6.1
17	seeing	<i>to</i> is a preposition here → -ing	6.2

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
18	such a	singular noun after the adjective → <i>such a</i>	6.3
19	it off	pronoun in the middle of a separable verb	8.2
20	aren't you	mirror <i>you're</i> : positive → negative tag	8.1

Module 7 (discussion, complaints, interviews) is tested through Listening C, Words & Phrases C, Writing A, and the interview. Lesson 8.3 is tested through the interview's short talk.

◆ PART 4 • READING / 15

1	No	she studied accounting
2	Yes	
3	Yes	"most evenings"
4	No	one of the cooks got sick
5	Doesn't say	we only know she'll cook her grandmother's recipes
6	She stayed an extra hour and practiced cutting vegetables.	either half is enough
7	twelve (12)	
8	Open her own (small) restaurant.	
9	25	
10	12:30 (p.m.)	accept "half past twelve"
11	Any one: answering calls · booking appointments · welcoming / checking in patients · dealing with questions or complaints	

◆ PART 5 • WRITING / 20

- ◆ **A. Complaint email (8 × 1 pt).** +1 a suitable greeting (*Dear Customer Service / Dear Sir or Madam*). +1 an opening that states the purpose (*I'm writing to complain about...*). +1 what they bought and when. +1 the screen problem described clearly. +1 the late delivery mentioned. +1 what they want (refund, replacement, repair). +1 the request is polite and indirect (*Would it be possible...? / I'd appreciate it if you could...*). +1 a polite close with a name, and no blunt or rude language anywhere.
- ◆ **B. Opinion essay (12).** Score with the **writing rubric** below: four criteria × 0–3.

Model answer A (8/8): Dear Customer Service, I'm writing to complain about a laptop I bought from your website on May 3. First, it arrived four days late. I'm afraid there is also a bigger problem: the screen doesn't work. It stays black when I turn the laptop on. Would it be possible to send me a replacement? If not, I'd appreciate it if you could give me a full refund. My order number is TW-2281. I look forward to hearing from you. Best regards, Ana Silva

Model answer B (B1+, 12/12, ~140 words): In my opinion, working from home is better for most office workers, but not for everyone. First of all, you save time. I used to spend two hours a day on the bus, and now I use that time to exercise. Another point is that many people concentrate better at home, because the office is noisy. On the other hand, it can be lonely. My colleague, who lives alone, says she misses talking to people. Some people also say that new staff learn faster in the office, and I think that's a good point. If companies let workers

12	No	"You don't have to..."	choose two or three days at home, everyone would be happier. To sum up, working from home has more advantages than disadvantages, but a mix is probably the best answer.
13	A résumé and a (short) email	both needed for the point	
14	Friday, June 12	accept "June 12" or "Friday"	
15	The clinic serves many Spanish- and Vietnamese-speaking families.	accept "many patients speak other languages"	

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (FINAL TEST)

- ◆ **Past perfect overuse or underuse** (12): "When I had arrived, the train had left" or "the train left" for the earlier event. Ask "Which happened first?"
- ◆ **"will" in time clauses** (14: "as soon as I will get"). It's the same rule as the first conditional, so link the two when you give feedback.
- ◆ **Articles** (16): "My sister is engineer." Speakers of Arabic, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Russian, and many other languages without articles will make this for a long time. It rarely blocks meaning, so don't let it dominate feedback.
- ◆ **"looking forward to see"** (17), **"so good movie"** (18), **"turn off it"** (19), **"isn't it" as a universal tag** (20: common for speakers of Indian English, Tagalog, and languages with one fixed tag).
- ◆ **Writing:** complaints that are too direct ("Give me my money") or so polite the request disappears. In essays, a list of reasons with no example, and *Although...*, *but...*
- ◆ **Listening:** item 8 (digit order) and item 10 (two requests in one call). Accept only the right answer, but note it: they're real-life skills.

SPEAKING RUBRIC · BOTH TESTS

Five criteria, each 0–3 (total /15). 0 = no response, or only L1. The bands follow the CEFR qualitative aspects of spoken language (range, accuracy, fluency, interaction, coherence, phonological control). The B1 column paraphrases the Council of Europe's B1 descriptors (*CEFR Companion Volume*, 2020). For the progress test, judge against Modules 1–4 language only.

CRITERION	NOT YET B1 (1)	B1 (2)	B1+ STRONG (3)
Task & coherence /3	Short, separate answers at A2 level; can't keep a story going or give a reason without a model.	Tells a story or describes an experience as a simple sequence of points; gives brief reasons and explanations for opinions; the short talk has a beginning, middle, and end.	Develops the story and the talk with relevant detail and examples; signposts clearly; argues a point in the discussion with more than one reason.
Range /3	Only everyday A2 language; gaps stop the task, and the learner falls back on L1 or single words.	Enough language to get by on familiar topics (work, town, travel, news, interests), with some hesitation and rephrasing ("the thing you use to...").	Varied language on familiar topics; opinion and signposting phrases, some phrasal verbs, and collocations used naturally; rephrases smoothly.
Accuracy /3	Frequent errors in basic structures (tense, word order) that sometimes hide the meaning.	Uses a repertoire of common patterns reasonably accurately in familiar situations. Errors happen (tense choice, articles, prepositions), but it is clear what they mean.	Good control of the course's main structures (present perfect vs past, narrative tenses, conditionals, reported speech, the passive). Errors rarely affect meaning and are sometimes self-corrected.
Interaction /3	Answers simple questions but can't keep an exchange going; needs a lot of help.	Starts, keeps going, and closes a conversation on familiar topics; agrees and disagrees politely; asks for clarification or repetition when needed.	Keeps a discussion moving; follow-up questions, reactions (<i>Oh really? Did you?</i>), invites the other person's view, defends a position when challenged.
Pronunciation & fluency /3	Often hard to follow; long pauses; the listener has to ask for repetition many times.	Keeps going understandably, even though pauses to plan and repair are very evident in longer turns. Clearly intelligible despite a foreign accent.	Fairly even tempo with few long pauses; word stress and intonation (e.g. falling tags) help meaning; contractions used naturally.

WRITING RUBRIC · FINAL TEST PART 5B

Four criteria, each 0–3 (total /12). 0 = nothing written, or nothing in English. At B1 the learner can write straightforward connected texts on familiar subjects by linking a series of shorter elements into a linear sequence, and can write short, simple essays on topics of interest, giving reasons for their views (paraphrased from the CEFR).

CRITERION	NOT YET B1 (1)	B1 (2)	B1+ STRONG (3)
Task & content /3	Under 80 words, or an opinion with no clear reasons; drifts off the question.	100–150 words; a clear opinion with two reasons and at least one example; mentions the other side briefly.	A well-developed answer: opinion, two or three supported reasons, the other side answered, and a conclusion that follows.
Organization & linking /3	A list of sentences; few linking words; no clear beginning or end.	A linear sequence with an opening, reasons, and a conclusion; common linkers (<i>First of all, For example, On the other hand, To sum up</i>).	Logical paragraphing; a range of linkers used accurately (including <i>which is why, what's more, although</i>); ideas flow.
Range /3	Repeats the same words and structures ("I think... I think...").	Enough vocabulary for the topic; some B1 structures (a conditional, a relative clause, a gerund subject, <i>used to</i>).	Varied vocabulary and several B1 structures used naturally (second conditional, reported opinion, passive, relative clauses).
Accuracy /3	Frequent errors that make the reader stop and guess.	Reasonably accurate; errors (articles, prepositions, tense) don't stop understanding; punctuation mostly correct.	Few errors, mostly small slips; sentences and punctuation well controlled.

WHAT THE SCORES MEAN

◆ PROGRESS TEST 1 (/70): A DIAGNOSIS, NOT A VERDICT

SCORE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT TO DO IN WEEKS 7–13
56–70	Strong. Modules 1–4 are secure.	Give the stretch task in every lesson. Ask them to lead discussions, and to give quieter classmates the first turn.
42–55	On track, with gaps in one or two sections.	Point the learner to the online lessons behind their missed items (use the lesson column above). Recycle those points in warmers.
28–41	Needs targeted support.	A short one-to-one: which part felt hard? Agree on two online lessons to redo with 🎧 Listen, usually Lessons 1.1 and 3.2. Use the literacy-support options in every class. Check attendance.
0–27	Something is getting in the way.	Talk privately and gently. Check vision, hearing, literacy, attendance, and life stress, and whether the learner was placed at the right level. Re-check with the shared placement test ; the A2 course may be a better fit for now. Keep them welcome while you decide together.

Class analysis: add up each section for the whole class and divide by the number of learners. A section average under 60% is a class problem, not an individual one. Build a 5–10 minute recycle into the warmers of Classes 14–19 (for example, a "Have you ever...? → When did you...?" chain if items 1–2 are weak, which also sets up Module 5's storytelling; or a reported-speech whisper game if rewrites 11–13 are weak).

◆ FINAL TEST (/100): GRADE TO OUTCOME

OUTCOME	GUIDELINE	WHAT TO TELL THE LEARNER AND PROGRAM
Ready for B2	70+ total and Speaking 10+/15 (mostly B1 or B1+ on the rubric).	Recommend Confident English (B2 Upper-Intermediate) , free online at rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/ . Learners at 88+ with Speaking 13+ are strong B1+ and can move quickly through the first B2 module. Learners with workplace or exam goals can also add Business English or IELTS Preparation alongside B2 (see the shared toolkit).
B2 with a review plan	55–69 total with Speaking 8+, or 70+ with Speaking 8–9.	Move on to B2 with a written review plan : the 3–4 B1 online lessons behind their weakest items (see the lesson column), done with 🎧 Listen before B2 Week 3. Lessons 1.1, 3.2, 5.1, and 6.2 are the usual ones. Speaking 8–9 learners also benefit from a conversation group.
Repeat B1 with support	Below 55 total, or Speaking 7 or below.	Recommend a second lap of B1, framed as consolidation and not failure ("The second time, you'll use these structures without thinking, and your talks will be longer."). Add a conversation group or a volunteer tutor if your program has them. If the score was very low, re-check with the shared placement test.
Literacy pathway	Speaking 10+ and Listening 11+/15, but Reading + Writing under 18/35.	Oral English is ready for B2 and literacy is the barrier. Don't hold them back for literacy alone. Recommend B2 plus a reading and writing class or tutor. If B2 can't support them, repeat B1 with a literacy focus and say clearly why.

These are **guidelines**. Your thirteen weeks of observation count as much as one test on one day. A learner who was ill, anxious, or grieving on test day deserves a re-test or a quick re-check with the shared placement test before any "repeat" recommendation. Record the outcome and a one-line reason for your program.

GIVING FEEDBACK KINDLY

◆ PRINCIPLES

- ◆ **Private, always.** Never read scores aloud or return papers in score order.
- ◆ **Strength first, then one next step.** One concrete step, not a list of errors.

◆ PHRASES THAT WORK AT B1

You did a great job. 🌟

Your stories are much easier to follow now.

You disagreed so politely. That's a real skill!

- ◆ **Name the progress.** Compare with Week 1, not with classmates.
- ◆ **Fluency before accuracy.** At B1, praise what they *communicated* (a reason, a story, a polite disagreement) before you mention a form.
- ◆ **Clear English, plus L1 if you share it.** Say the key message twice and check that it landed: "So, what's your next class?"
- ◆ **Written note to take home,** because family members may help read it.
- ◆ **Adults decide.** Offer the recommendation and the reason, and let the learner choose when the program allows it.

Your talk had a clear beginning, middle, and end.

Practice this: I've lived here **for** two years / **since** 2024.

Do Lesson 3.2 again at home. Click  Listen.

Your next class: Confident English (B2). 

One more B1 class. It'll feel easier the second time.

I'm proud of you.

SAY: *Thirteen weeks ago you chose between two tenses. Today you gave a talk and defended your opinion!*

SAY: *Your speaking is ready for B2. Reading and writing need more time, so let's find a reading class too.*

AVOID

Red ink everywhere, percentages without meaning ("62%"), the word "fail", comparisons ("Maria got 90"), and correcting a learner's L1 accent as though it were an error. Don't grade opinions: a learner who disagrees with you, clearly and politely, has done exactly what B1 asks. If a learner cries or goes quiet, pause the conversation and come back to it. The number can wait.